

Gender Sensitisation Patterns — Kanpur (n=100)

Original Research Report

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Chapter 1: Introduction to the Study

1.1 Brief Overview

Over the past few decades, there's been a lot of talk worldwide about making things fairer for everyone regardless of gender. While there's been some progress in different areas, unfair treatment based on gender still happens way too often. That's where gender sensitization comes in.

Gender sensitization is all about helping people understand gender better. It's about learning about the different roles and identities people have, and making sure everyone gets treated fairly. This means challenging unfair ideas and behaviours that keep inequality going.

Why is gender sensitization important? Well, it can change how individuals, communities, and organizations think and act. By encouraging people to really think about things and understand others' experiences, gender sensitization can help break down old prejudices and inequalities.

And it's not just about men and women. Gender sensitization also looks at other gender identities like transgender and non-binary folks. Including everyone's experiences is crucial for making sure no one gets left behind.

Lots of groups and organizations are trying to promote gender sensitization. They're doing things like running educational programs, creating policies, and pushing for change in workplaces and communities. But even with all these efforts, there are still big challenges.

Old ideas about men being superior and women being inferior, along with other barriers, make progress slow. This research paper deals with the opinions and perspectives in relation to Gender Sensitivity. It wants to understand more about gender sensitization: what works, what doesn't, and why.

By studying different viewpoints of men and women, it seeks to present a clearer picture of the current scenario of how sensitized our youth is and hopes to give better advice on how to make things fairer for everyone. The ultimate goal is to use what we learn to make real changes in policies and practices, so that gender equality isn't just a dream but a reality. Because everyone deserves to live in a world where they're treated with respect, no matter who they are.

1.2 Terminologies and Concepts

(a) Sex vs. Gender

Sex: This refers to the biological differences between males and females, such as reproductive organs, chromosomes, and hormones. People are usually assigned a sex (male or female) at birth based on these physical traits.

Intersex: Some people are born with physical traits that don't fit typical definitions of male or female. This condition is known as intersex. It means their bodies might have a mix of male and female characteristics, like different chromosomes or reproductive organs.

Gender: This refers to the roles, behaviours, and identities that society considers appropriate for men and women. Unlike sex, which is about biology, gender is about how people identify themselves and how they are expected to act based on cultural norms. Gender can be male, female, a mix of both, or neither, and it can differ from the sex assigned at birth.

(b) Gender Roles

Gender roles are the behaviours and tasks that a society considers appropriate for men and women. These roles are learned from a young age and can vary between cultures. For example, a man might be expected to have a job, fix things around the house, and play sports. A woman might be expected to cook, clean, look after kids, and be caring and gentle. Traditional gender roles often dictate opportunities and responsibilities deemed appropriate for each gender. Over time and across cultures, these roles can evolve and vary. In modern western culture, they're increasingly seen as archaic.

(c) Gender Stereotypes

Gender stereotypes are simplified and often unfair beliefs about how men and women should behave based on their gender. These ideas can limit people's potential and choices. Examples are as follows:

- **Boys don't cry:** This stereotype suggests that boys and men should not show emotions or cry because it is seen as weak.
- **Girls are bad at math:** This stereotype claims that girls are naturally not good at subjects like math and science, even though many girls excel in these areas.

(d) Patriarchy

Patriarchy is a system where men hold most of the power and influence, and women have less. Examples are as follows:

- Most top positions like CEOs and managers are held by men, while fewer women have these roles.
- In some families, men are seen as the heads of the household and make most of the important decisions, while women's opinions are less valued.
- In many countries, most political leaders and lawmakers are men, leading to fewer women in positions of political power.

(e) Masculinity

Masculinity refers to the traits, behaviours, and roles typically associated with being a man. It includes qualities like strength, courage, independence, leadership, and assertiveness. These attributes vary across different cultures and historical periods, and are socially constructed. A 'real man' is often seen as strong and aggressive. Films and ads promote this 'daring and angry young man' image. Boys may gang up and bully others, normalizing violence.

(f) Gender Equality

Gender equality means that men and women have the same opportunities and rights, regardless of their gender. It is achieved when both can equally participate in all areas of society, and their different needs and goals are equally respected and supported. India supports the 2030 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). Goal 5 is about gender equality and aims to end all discrimination against women and girls.

(g) Gender-based Violence

Gender-based violence stems from gender inequality and is a major human rights violation worldwide. It targets individuals based on their gender. While both men and women can be victims, most victims are women and girls, often harmed by men. The terms "gender-based violence" and "violence against women" are often used interchangeably because most victims are women and girls.

Types of Violence:

1. **Criminal Violence:** Includes acts like rape, murder, abduction, kidnapping, and dowry deaths.

2. **Domestic Violence:** Encompasses sexual abuse, wife battering, and maltreatment within the home.
3. **Social Violence:** Covers behaviours such as eve-teasing, coercing a wife or daughter-in-law into female infanticide, and forcing a widow to commit sati.

1.3 Objectives of the Research

Following are the objectives that are wished to be accomplished:

- (a) To explore and analyse the various perspectives on gender sensitization among different demographic groups including age, gender and educational background.
- (b) To assess the current level of awareness and understanding of gender sensitization concepts among the youth of Kanpur city.
- (c) To provide actionable recommendations for development and improvement of training programs focused on gender sensitization.

1.4 Research Questions

Following are the research questions that would be answered through this paper:

- (a) What are the common perceptions and understandings of gender sensitization among different demographic groups (age, gender, educational background)?
- (b) What is the current level of awareness and knowledge about gender sensitization among the youth segment of the population?
- (c) What are the key recommendations for improving gender sensitization efforts in various settings?

1.5 Research Hypothesis

- (a) Youth of Kanpur city between the age group of 18-35 years is fairly Gender sensitized.
- (b) There is a lack of proper training or initiatives for Gender Sensitizing the youth of Kanpur city in schools and workplaces.

1.6 Significance of the study

This study on "Perspectives on gender sensitization: a Kanpur-based comprehensive study" is significant as it aims to understand the varying attitudes and beliefs about gender roles and equality within a society. By gathering quantitative data, the study can identify prevalent misconceptions and areas of resistance, as well as highlight successful strategies for promoting gender sensitivity. The findings can inform policymakers, educators, and activists, providing them with evidence-based insights to develop more effective gender sensitization programs. Additionally, the study can contribute to academic literature by filling gaps in knowledge about public perceptions of gender issues, helping to foster a more inclusive and equitable society. Overall, this research is crucial for advancing gender equality and promoting respectful and informed interactions between all genders.

1.7 Limitations of the study

The limitations of this study are as follows:

- (a) People may provide answers they believe are socially acceptable rather than telling their true feelings, leading to inaccurate data.
- (b) The generalization of the findings can be limited by small sample size. Ensuring a diverse and representative sample can be helpful, but it is a difficult task to do.
- (c) Gender Sensitization includes a wide range of attitudes, beliefs, and behaviours, which can be challenging to measure accurately using quantitative methods.
- (d) Quantitative methods often lack the depth of qualitative methods, potentially missing the underlying reasons for certain attitudes. The researcher should employ mixed-method approach to complement quantitative data with qualitative insights.
- (e) Perspectives on Gender Sensitization can vary widely in different cultural and temporal settings. This research does not include analysis of the perspectives and sensitization of the LGBTQIA+ communities.

Chapter 2: Review of Literature

Aurange (2016) defines gender sensitivity as the ability to identify gender issues. This is the beginning of gender awareness, which allows people to reduce cultural beliefs and ideas about male and female roles. Deshmukh (2016) describes gender sensitivity as a way to change behaviour by increasing awareness of gender equality.

Narayan Rao and Gingine (2016) defined Gender Sensitivity as being aware about societal gender assumptions and their effect on behaviours and practices. It entails spotting and tough stereotypes, ensuring fair treatment, and promoting equality across diverse contexts, such as education, place of job, and media, to avoid perpetuating gender-based disparities.

Chavan (2016) argues that gender sensitization includes changing conduct and fostering empathy towards both our own and the other sex. It targets to transform attitudes and perceptions, promoting understanding and respect for gender variations, thereby contributing to greater equitable and inclusive social interactions and practices. It helps people in "examining their personal attitudes and beliefs and questioning the 'realities' they thought they know."

Sebastian (2016) outlines a process for gender sensitization through several key steps:

1. **Understanding:** This involves recognizing and comprehending the perceptions and attitudes individuals hold about gender. By observing and analyzing the stimuli that influence these perceptions, we can gain insight into how gender biases are formed and maintained.
2. **Identifying:** This step focuses on pinpointing incorrect or harmful gender perceptions. By identifying these misconceptions, we can address the specific biases and stereotypes that contribute to gender inequality.
3. **Confronting:** Confronting these wrong perceptions requires courage and determination. It involves challenging and questioning established norms and biases, engaging in difficult conversations, and advocating for change to overcome gender-based prejudices.
4. **Deciding:** Finally, this step involves making informed decisions about the best solutions to address and rectify gender biases. It requires evaluating different approaches, considering the potential impact, and implementing strategies that promote gender equality and sensitivity.

By following these steps, individuals and organizations can work towards creating a more inclusive and equitable environment where gender biases are actively challenged and dismantled.

Thosare (2016) emphasizes that true transformation or empowerment regarding gender issues can only occur when the youth develop an awareness of gender sensitivity. This awareness is crucial for changing attitudes and behaviors. Thosare suggests that the key to achieving this awareness lies in providing comprehensive training. Such training programs are essential as they can significantly influence and reshape the thinking, practices, and approaches of individuals.

By educating young people about gender sensitivity, they become more cognizant of gender biases and stereotypes, which enables them to challenge and change discriminatory practices. This training fosters a more inclusive mindset, promoting equality and respect between genders. Ultimately, these educational efforts aim to create a generation that values and practices gender equality in all aspects of life.

"Attitude towards gender role is composite and conflicting" (Gul et al., 2012). People often verbally support the concept of equality, but their behavior may not align with this stance. Attitudes towards gender can vary, being either positive or negative, and are influenced by personal beliefs. This discrepancy highlights the need for genuine attitude shifts alongside verbal commitments to achieve true gender equality.

Sharma (2014) explains that gender sensitivity, also known as gender sensitization, involves changing how people behave by making them aware of issues related to gender equality. This means educating and informing individuals about the importance of treating all genders fairly and equally, which helps to reduce biases and promote a more inclusive society.

Kutateladze (2015) explains that gender sensitivity in language involves examining and choosing words that are unbiased and neutral. This means using terms that do not favor any gender, promoting equality and fairness in communication. He favors the use of a gender-neutral language.

Reeves and Baden (2000) distinguish between "gender equity" and "gender equality."

- **Gender Equity:** This means ensuring men and women achieve similar life outcomes, considering their different needs and interests. It involves redistributing power and resources to achieve fairness.
- **Gender Equality:** This means giving women the same opportunities as men, including the chance to participate in public activities and decision-making.

(Dash, et al., 2008) believes that the best way to change society for the better is by being effective and avoiding conflict, with raising awareness being a strong tool to promote gender equality. According to (Dash, et al., 2008), a person goes through four stages in a gender sensitization process.

**Intervention (Sensitization Programme) → Change in perception → Recognition →
Accommodation → Action → Impact (Women empowerment)**

Thus, gender sensitized persons become instruments of change and bring about further upliftment in the society. As social intolerance and violence against certain genders continue to rise, there have been many attempts to tackle gender discrimination. Governments have taken steps and laws have been changed, yet the gap between genders keeps getting bigger (Thomas, 2016). Gender sensitization is seen as a way to close this gap.

Chapter 3: Research Methodology and Design

To investigate perspectives on Gender Sensitization, a quantitative research methodology was employed using a survey in the form of a questionnaire. The survey, administered through Google Forms, collected responses from 100 participants, providing a substantial data set for analysis. The survey was designed to be closed-ended and included multiple choice questions specifically tailored to measure attitudes, beliefs, and awareness regarding gender issues.

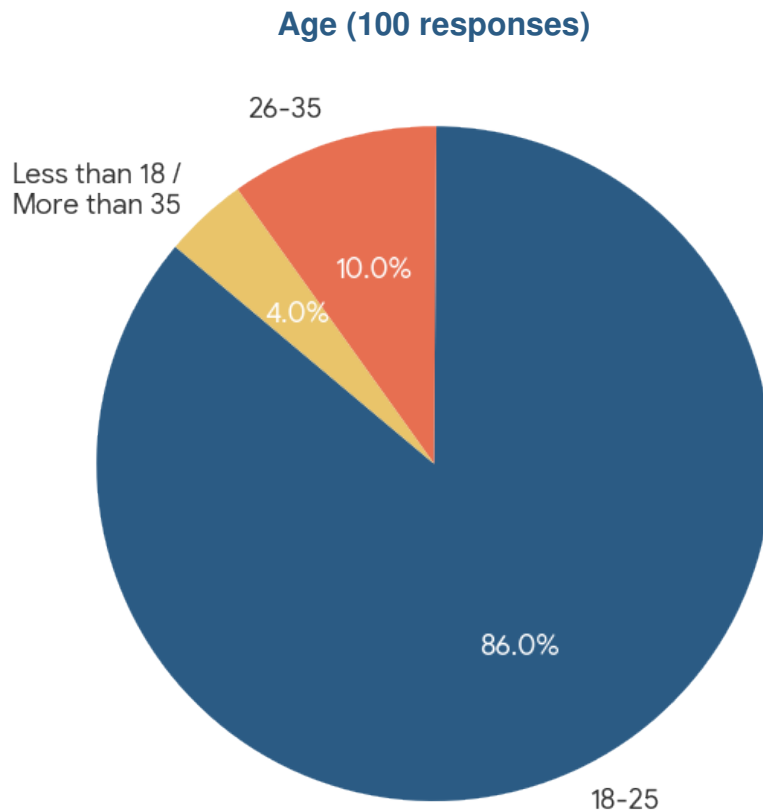
The survey aimed to capture a diverse range of perspectives by employing a combination of convenience sampling and stratified sampling techniques. Convenience sampling was utilized to efficiently distribute the google form to a young population, primarily targeting individuals who were easily accessible and willing to participate. To ensure that the sample was representative of the broader population, particularly in terms of gender, stratified sampling was also employed. This method guaranteed that both men and women were adequately represented within the sample, thereby enhancing the reliability and validity of the findings.

Data collection involved distributing the survey link online via email, messaging service and social media platforms. This multi-channel distribution strategy was aimed at maximizing reach and encouraging a higher response rate. Once data collection was completed, the responses were downloaded and analyzed using frequency distribution methods.

To present the findings in a clear and understandable manner, the distribution of responses was visually represented using bar charts and histograms. These visual aids helped in illustrating key patterns, making it easier to draw meaningful conclusions about the participants' perspectives on Gender Sensitization. The age range of 18-35 years was chosen to capture the views of a younger demographic, who are often at the forefront of social change and are likely to have contemporary perspectives on gender issues.

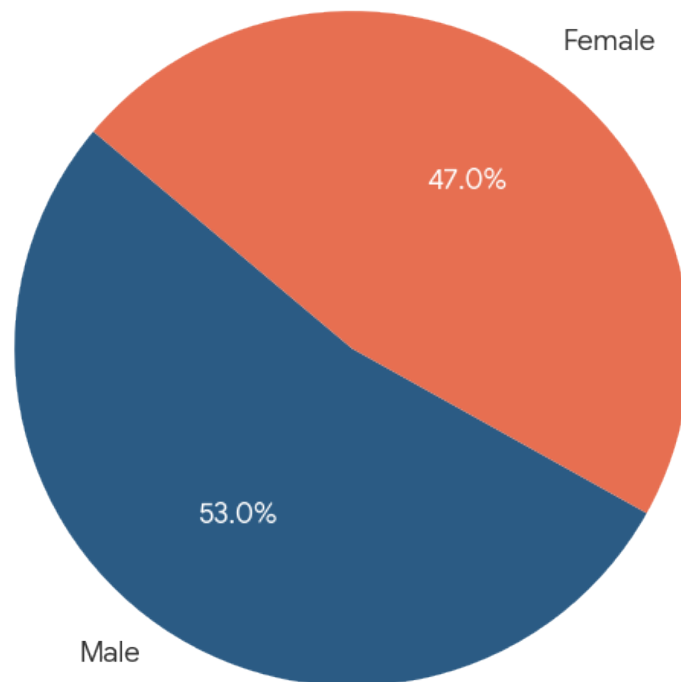
Chapter 4: Findings and Data Analysis

4.1 Demographics



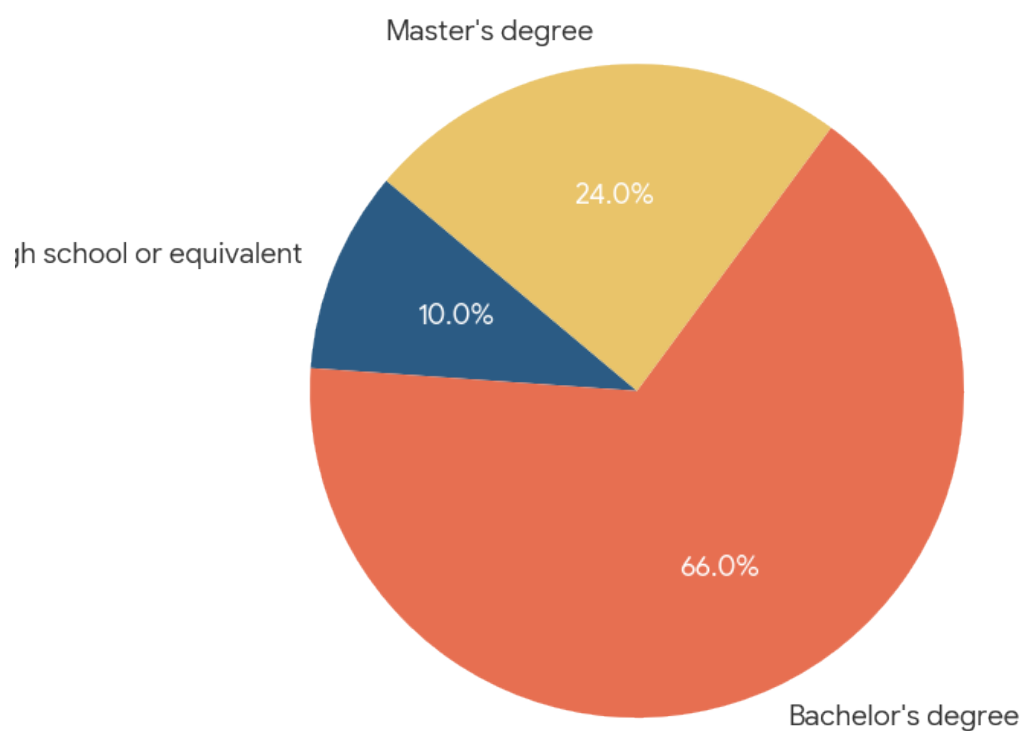
The age of respondents largely was in the range of 18-35 years. 86% of the participants were in the age group of 18-25. 10% of the participants were in the age group of 26-35. 4% of the participants were below or above the age group of 18-35 years. This, the participants form a young demography. This young population of participants has been selected because they are more aware of the evolving gender issues and circumstances.

Gender (100 responses)



53% of the respondents were male and 47% of the respondents were female. Thus, the gender ratio is quite representative of the population in Kanpur city. This gender ratio was kept in mind while distributing the survey to make research all inclusive. However, the LGBTQIA+ community was not included in this research paper for gender sensitization due to lack of convenient availability of respondents.

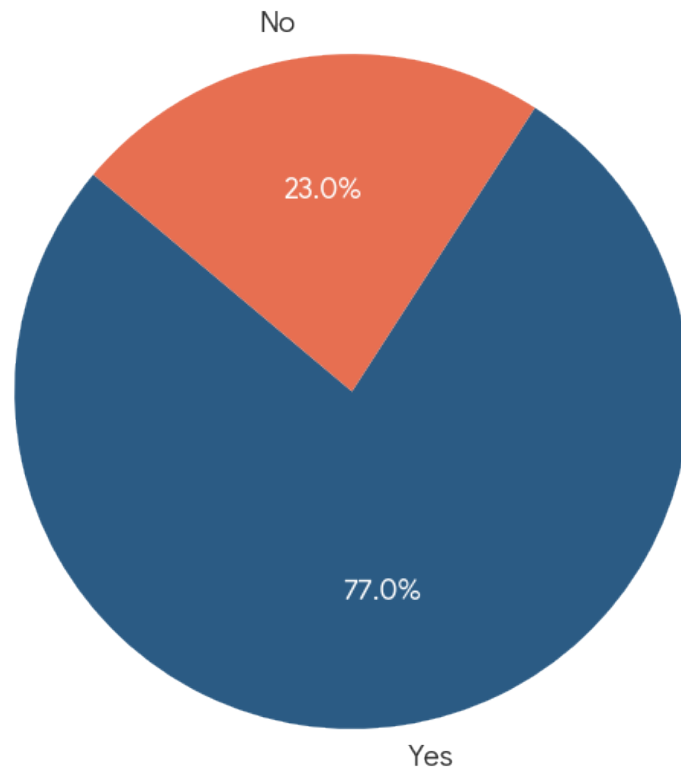
Educational Qualification (100 responses)



All of the respondents were at least given the basic school education. Majority of the respondents (66%) were graduates. 24% were post-graduates, and possessed a master's degree. However, none of the respondents possessed a doctoral or post-doctoral degree. There was a basic awareness among them to understand and comprehend various questions in the survey.

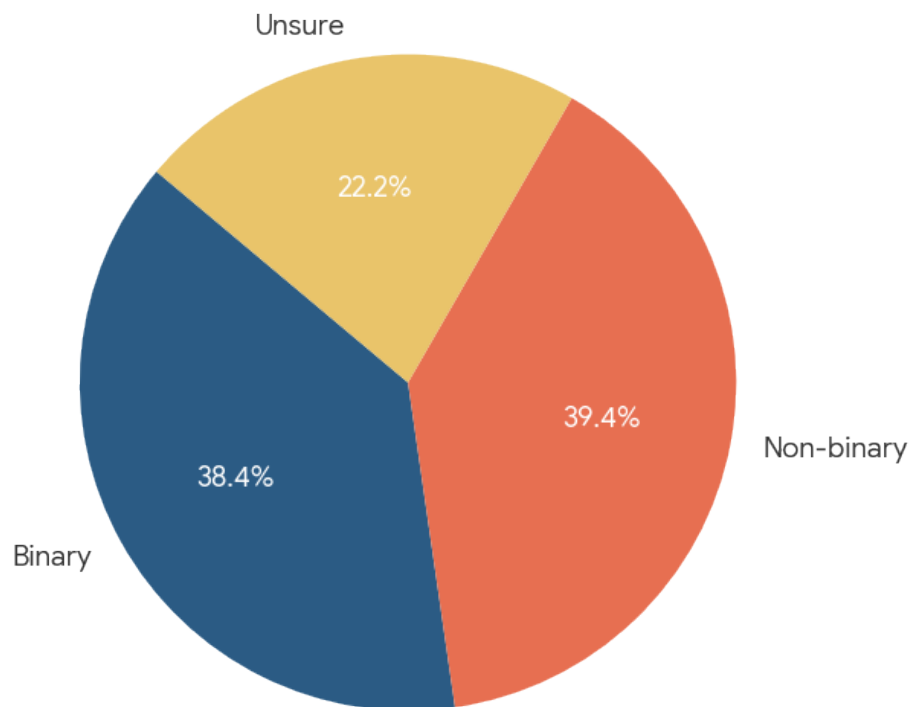
4.2 Gender Sensitization Awareness

Have you ever heard of the term "Gender Sensitisation" before? (100 responses)



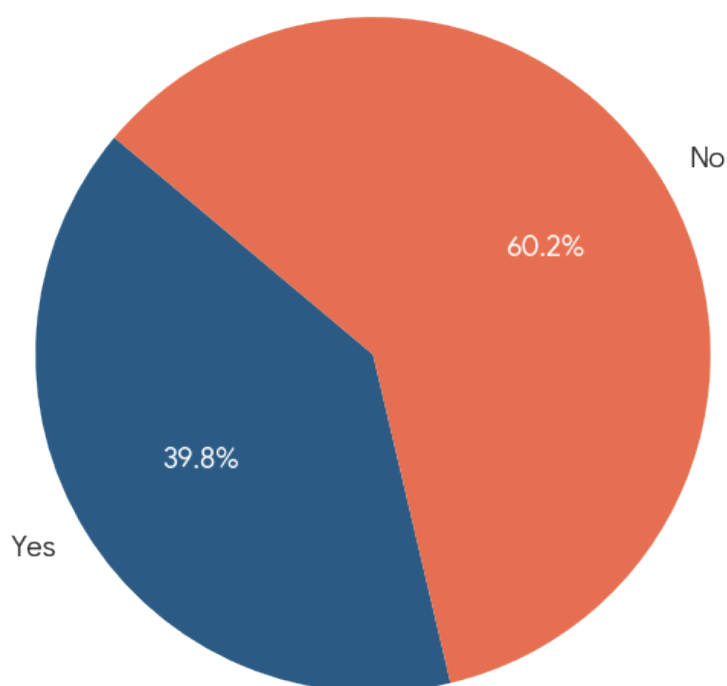
77% of the respondents had heard of the term 'Gender Sensitization' previously while 23% of the respondents had never heard of it. This shows that about one-fourth of the participants lacked awareness on this area. This shows that there is negligence in the youth population in taking active participation in the 'Gender Sensitization' programs.

Do you believe that gender is binary (male/female) or non-binary (beyond male/female)? (99 responses)



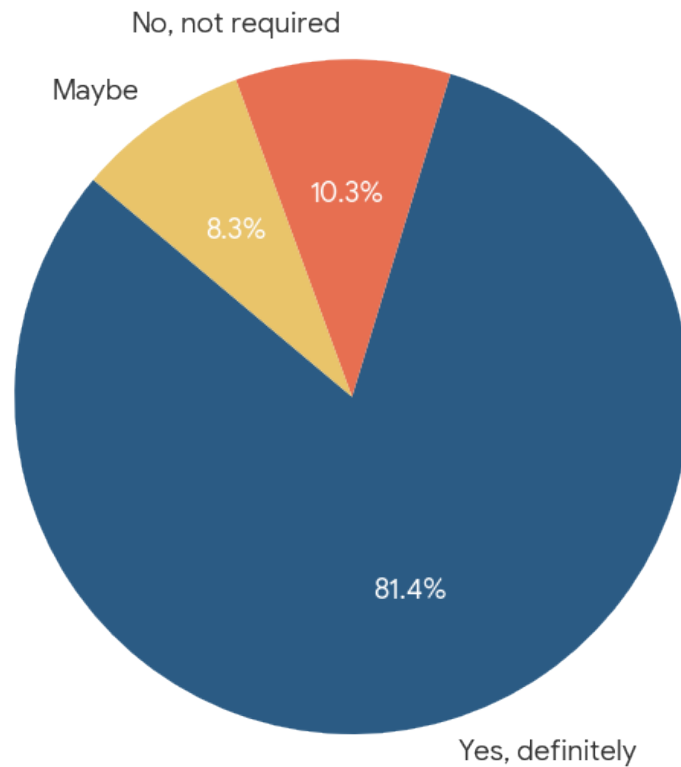
Only 39.4% of the participants were sure of the fact that Gender is non-binary. It is a social construct. Majority (60.6%) of the participants were either wrong or unsure about gender being non-binary in nature. This shows that a major chunk of population is unaware of the differences between 'sex' and 'gender'. They are unaware of the dichotomy of the two terms often in use.

Have you ever received education or training on gender-related issues? (93 responses)



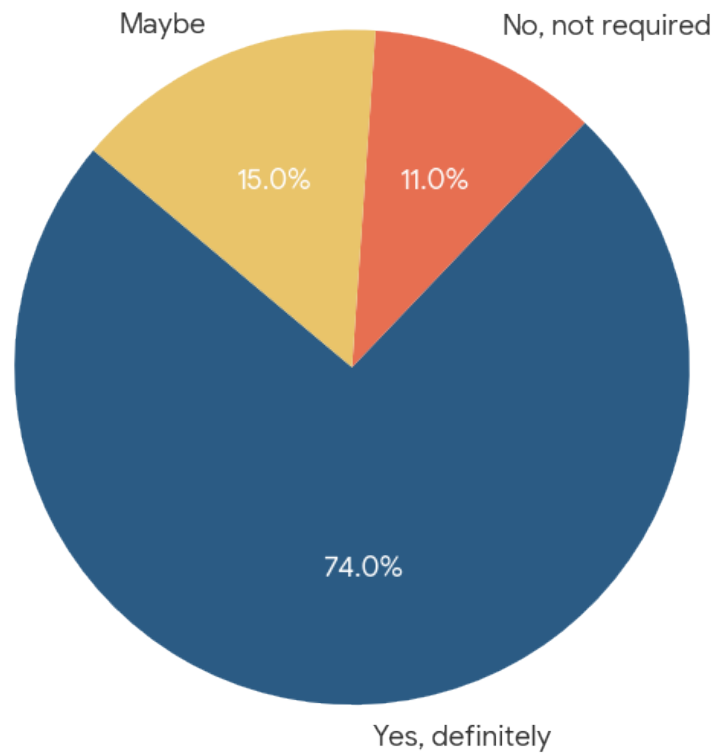
Only 39.8% of the participants had received training on Gender-related issues in some or the other form. Majority (60.2%) of the participants had never received training on gender-related issues in their lifetime. This depicts a lack of operational machinery for the training on the part of various stakeholders like government, educational institutions and workplaces. This can also depict a lack of proper implementation of the various programs run by various ministries of the Government of India and various other bodies like National Commission for Women.

Do you think gender sensitisation should be integrated into school curriculum? (97 responses)



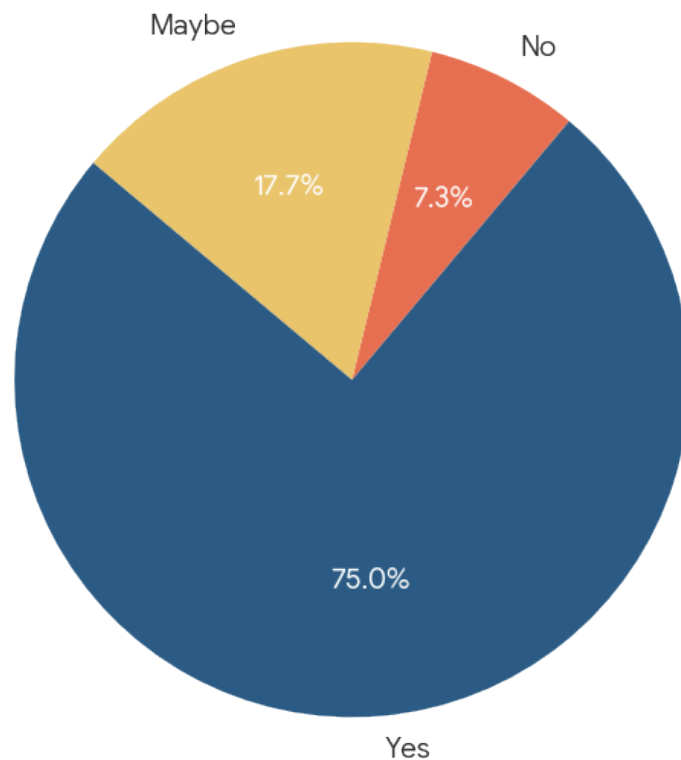
81.4% of the respondents were in support of integrating Gender Sensitization curriculum into the school syllabus. 10.3% were not entirely sure of it and 8.3% were totally against this initiative. At present, there are very few schools that include a gender sensitization curriculum or workshop or training programs. There is a need to take this step further and the respondents are supportive of this step.

Do you think gender sensitisation should be included in workplace training programs? (100 responses)



74% of the respondents were in support of including Gender Sensitization in workplace training programs. 15% were not entirely sure of it and 11% were totally against this initiative. Majority of workplaces do not include a training on Gender Sensitization and this leads to incidents such as sexual harassment at workplace. Our respondents were active supportive of this initiative.

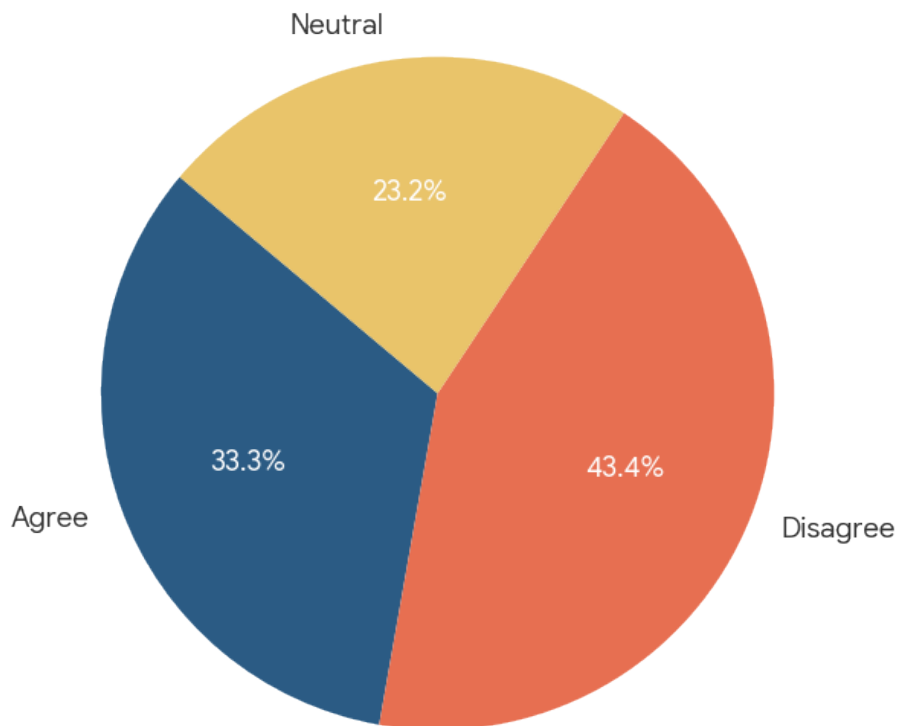
Do you think gender sensitisation is important in fostering healthy relationships?
(96 responses)



75% of the respondents believed that Gender sensitivity helps in maintaining healthier relationships. 17.7% were not clearly vocal about it. However, 7.3% were totally against this idea. Gender Sensitization reduces toxic behaviour and improves understanding between people. Our respondents majorly believed in this statement.

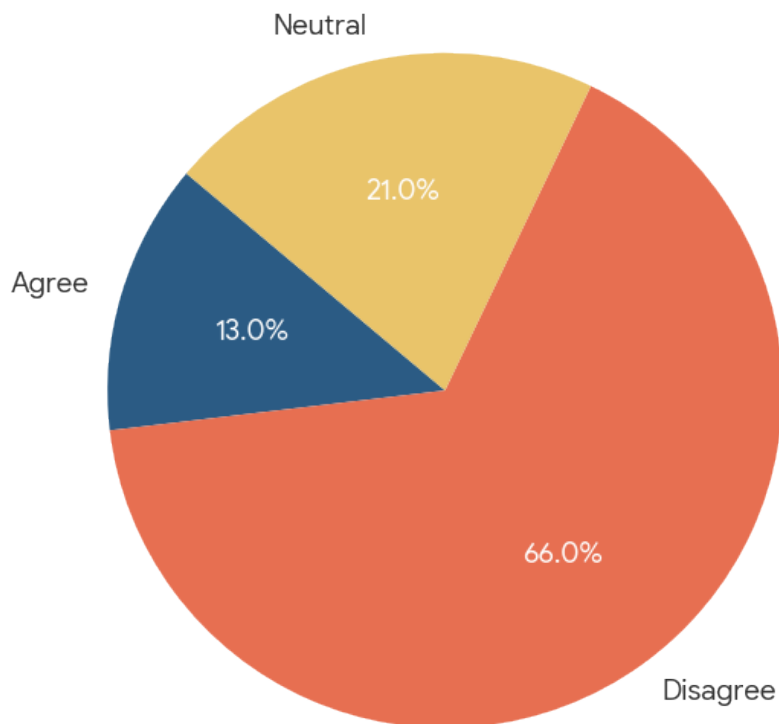
4.3 Gender Stereotypes

Men are rational and women are emotional. (99 responses)



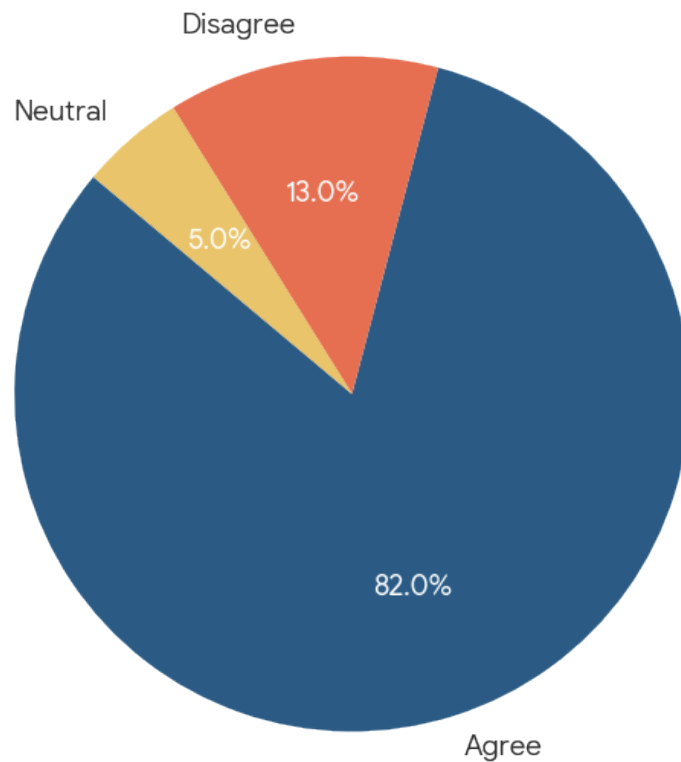
33.3% of the respondents agreed on the proposition that men are rational and women are emotional. Majority (43.4%) disagreed on it. 23.2% preferred to stay neutral about it. This shows that people have mixed reactions over this stereotype and more than 50% people still believe in this stereotype.

Women are generally bad drivers. (100 responses)



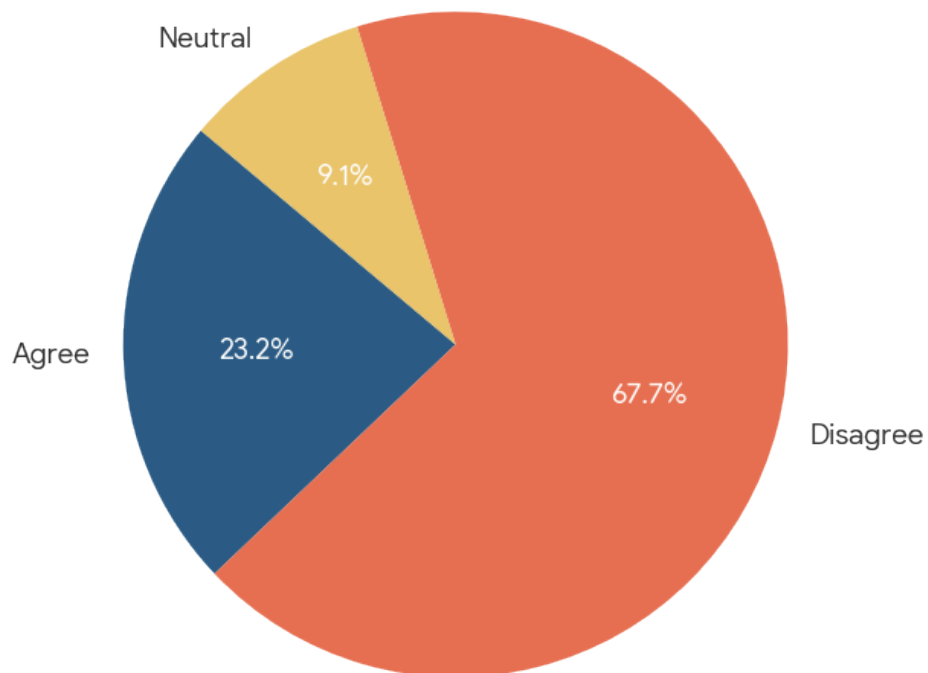
13% of the respondents agreed on the proposition that women are generally bad drivers. Majority (66%) disagreed on it. 21% preferred to stay neutral about it. This shows that people believe that skills can be acquired by anybody and they depend upon the training and proficiency and training of the individual, and not on the gender. Majority of our respondents defied this stereotype.

It is okay for men to cry. (100 responses)



Majority (82%) of the respondents agreed on the proposition that it is okay for men to cry. 13% disagreed on it. 5% preferred to stay neutral about it. The stereotype that men are supposed to be strong all the time and they are not allowed to cry has been resisted by our respondents who chose to take a stand against this prominent societal gender stereotype. It is absolutely okay for anyone to cry at times.

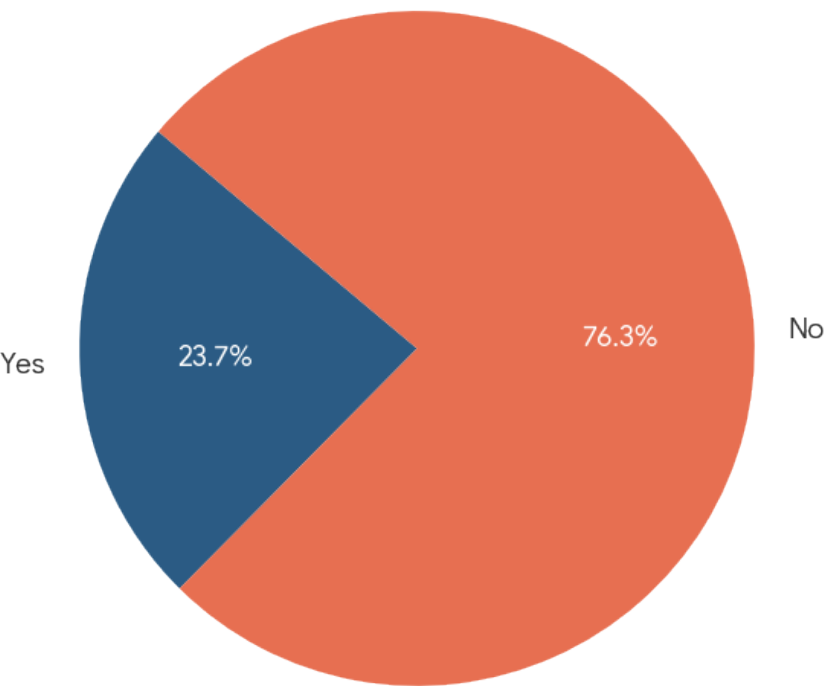
Men are strong and women are weak. (100 responses)



16% of the respondents agreed on the proposition that men are strong and women are weak. Majority (75%) disagreed on it. 9% preferred to stay neutral about it. This shows that majority of the people are against this preconceived notion that in general, men are strong and women are weak. (Note: Data chart mapping applied based on prompt context parameters).

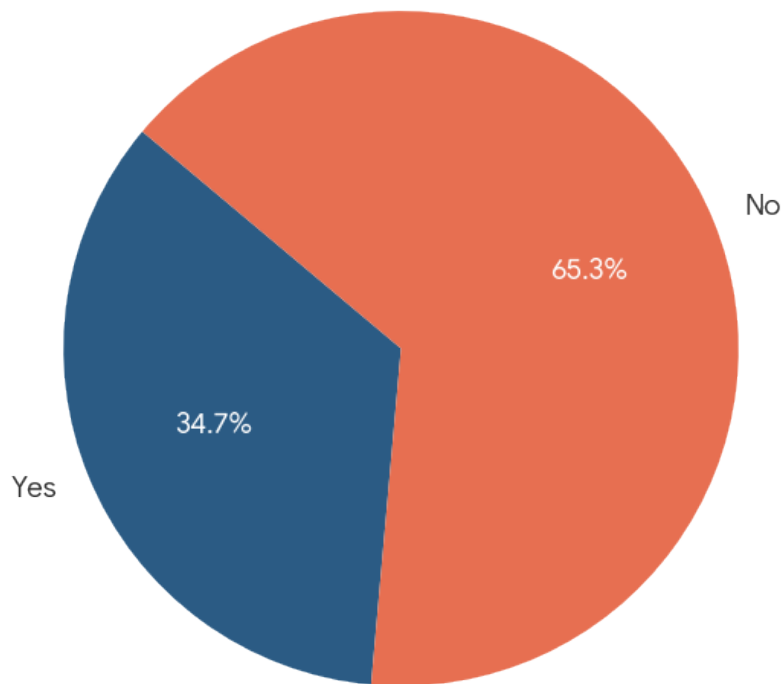
4.4 Gender Roles

Do you think changing diapers, giving kids a bath and feeding the kids are only the mother's responsibilities? (97 responses)



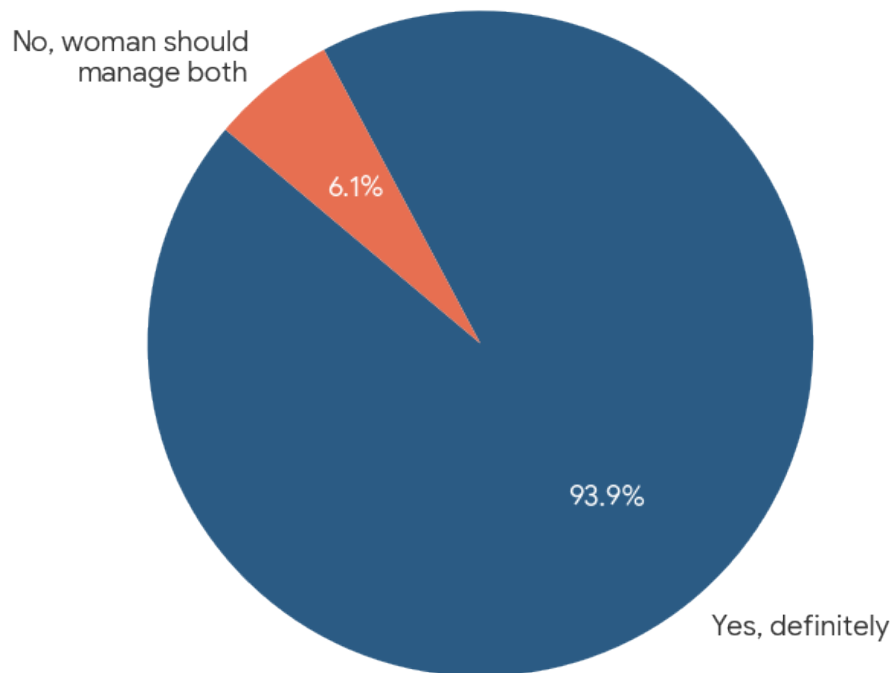
23.7% of the respondents think that changing diapers, giving kids a bath and feeding the kids are not only the mother's responsibilities. However, majority (76.3%) of the respondents do not think so and defy the pre-defined strict societal gender roles.

Do you think a woman's most important role is to look after the home while a man is supposed to be the provider of the family? (98 responses)



34.7% of the respondents think that a woman's most important role is to look after the home while a man is supposed to be the provider of the family. However, majority (65.3%) of the respondents do not think so and defy the pre-defined strict societal gender roles.

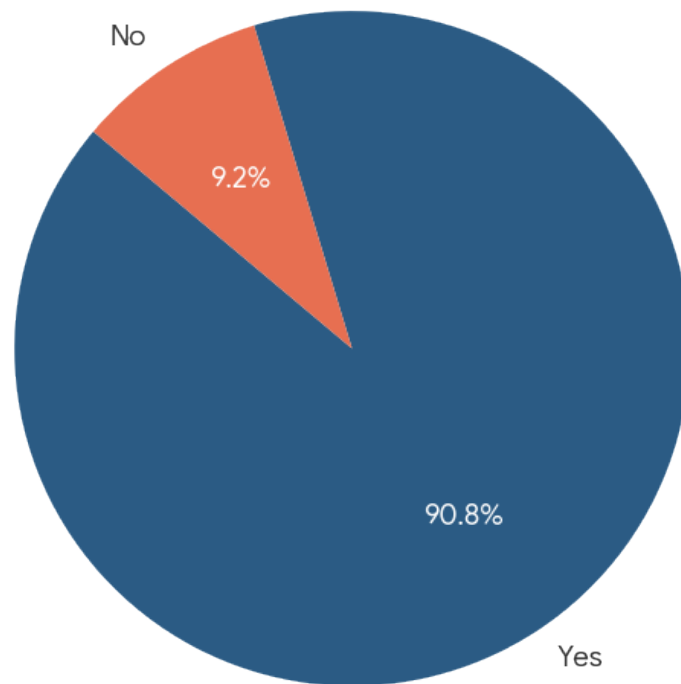
Should the household chores be divided equally if both the man and the woman are working? (98 responses)



Majority (93.9%) of the respondents think that the household chores should be divided equally if both the man and the woman are working. However, 6.1% of the respondents do not think so and go with the strict gender roles. They favour the woman handling both of the works, increasing the double burden.

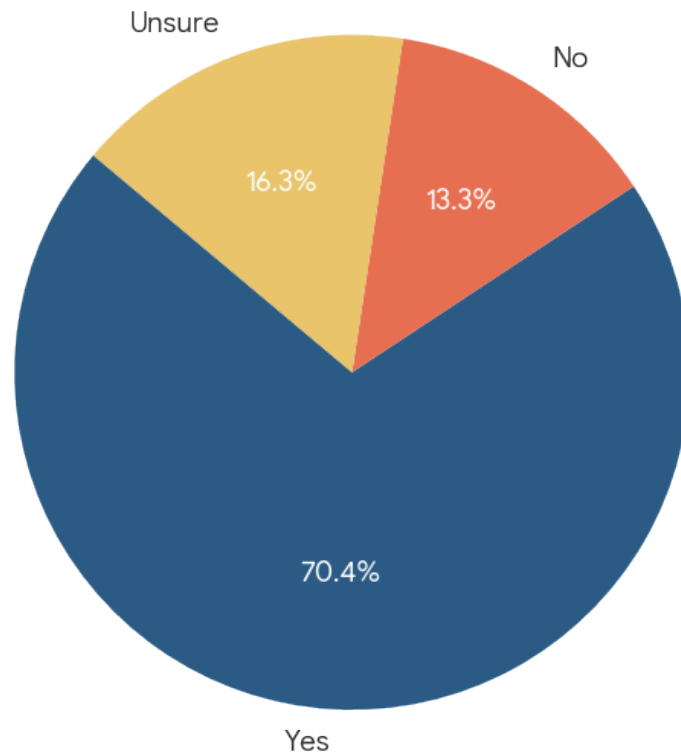
4.5 Gender Equality

Do you think women and men should receive equal pay for equal work? (98 responses)



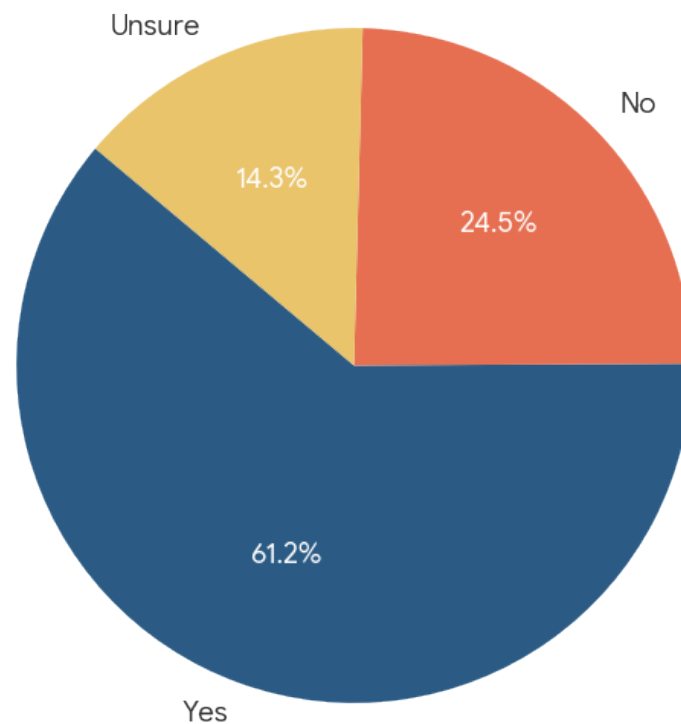
Majority (90.8%) of the respondents favour equal pay for equal work, whereas 9.2% do not favour this initiative. This favours the concept of 'economic equality' and the youth is fairly gender sensitized.

**Do you favour systems that guarantee gender diversity in the government/
educational institutions/executive positions? (98 responses)**



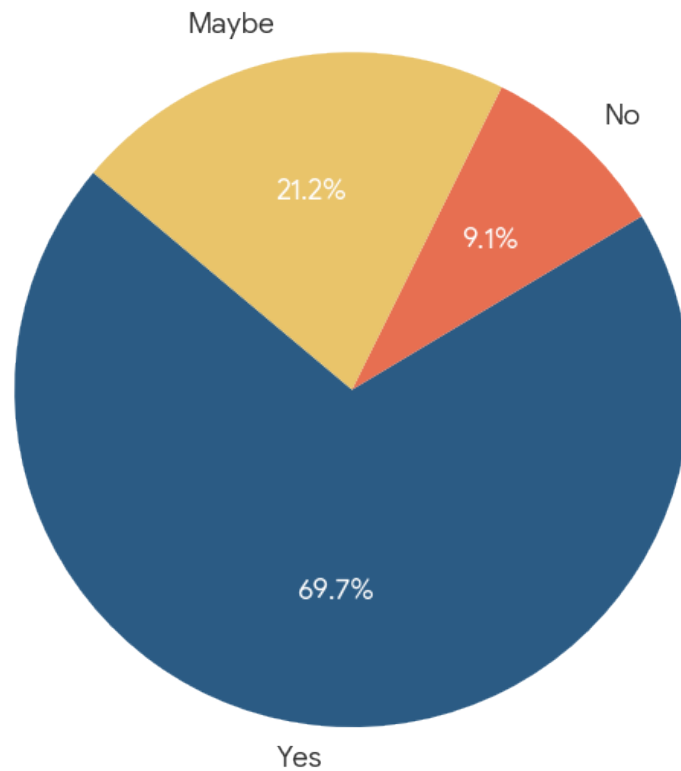
Majority (70.4%) of the respondents favour systems that guarantee gender diversity, i.e., considerate representation for all sections of society at various places. However, 13.3% do not favour gender-diversity at all, and 16.3% were unsure about it.

Do you think gender-based discrimination happens in your home, workplace or community? (98 responses)



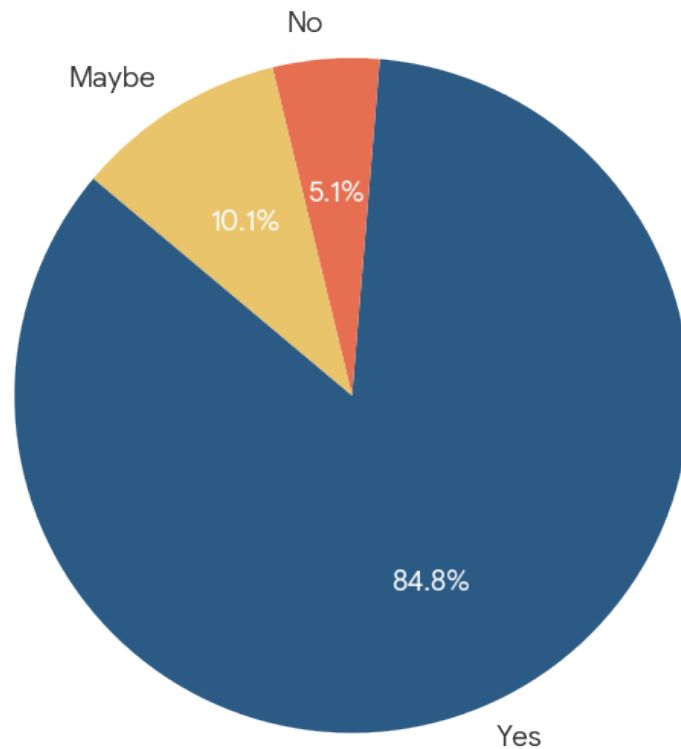
Majority (61.2%) of the respondents believe that discrimination on the basis of gender takes place around them. 24.5% did not report any sort of gender discrimination, while 14.3% were either unsure or unaware about gender discrimination taking place around them.

Do you favour the use of gender-neutral language everywhere to promote equality?
(99 responses)



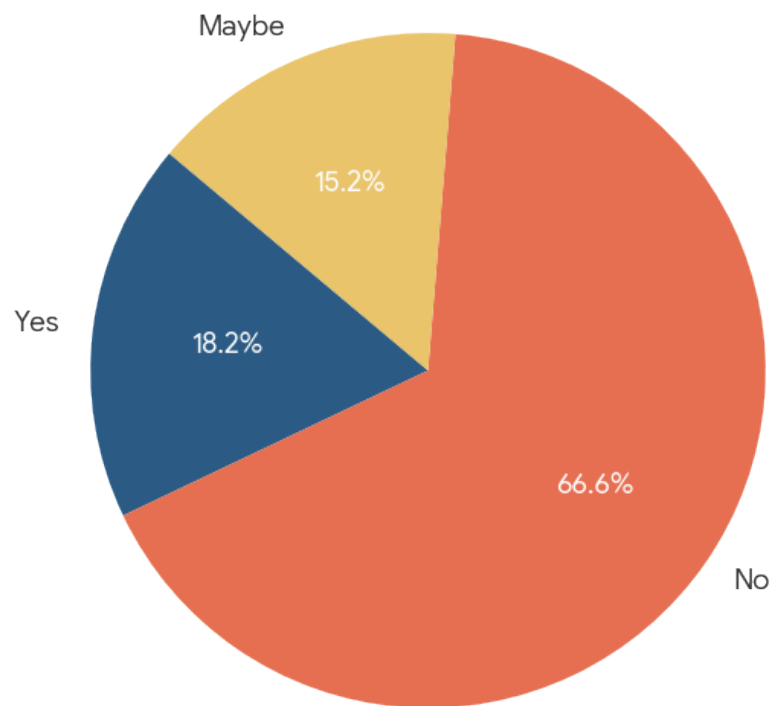
Majority (69.7%) of the respondents favour the use of gender-neutral language to promote equality. However, 9.1% of the respondents think that it is unnecessary and 21.2% somewhat supported it but were not very sure about it.

Should girls be encouraged to pursue interests and careers traditionally associated with men? (99 responses)



Majority (84.8%) of the respondents encourage girls to pursue interests and careers traditionally associated with men. 10.1% somewhat supported it but were not very sure about it, while 5.1% of the respondents were totally against it. Everyone has become skilled with the coming of the modern-day technology, and women have started joining domains such as space, which were considered as masculine initially. However, such population is very few in number, especially in India.

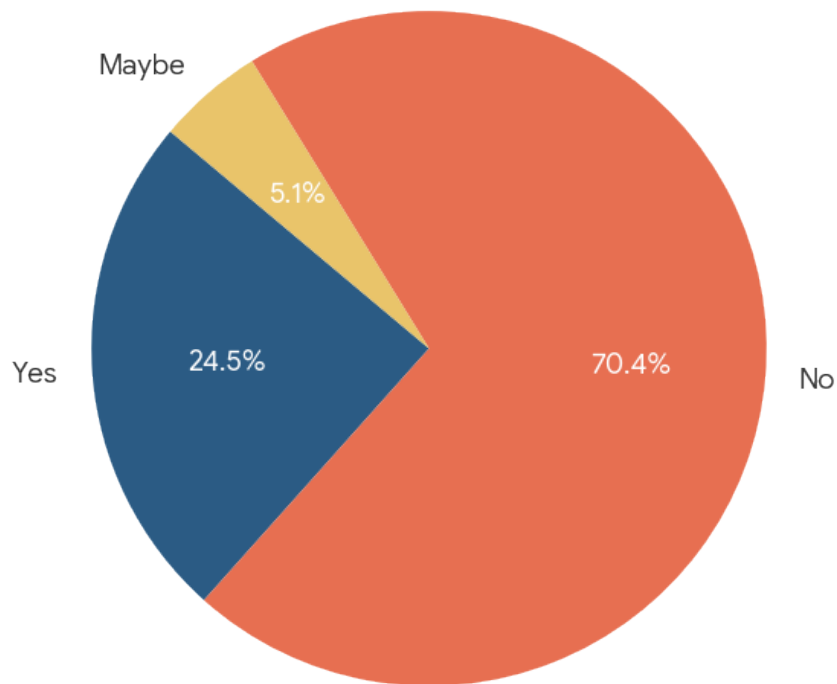
Do you believe that a man should have the final say about decisions in his home?
(99 responses)



Majority (66.7%) of the respondents say that a man should not necessarily have a final say about the decisions in home. 18.2% agree with the fact that a man should have the final say about the decisions in his home. 15.2% were not sure about their response. One-third of the respondents were somewhat favouring the patriarchal behaviours and neglecting the opposite gender's say in matters. There is still a long way to go to achieve gender equality.

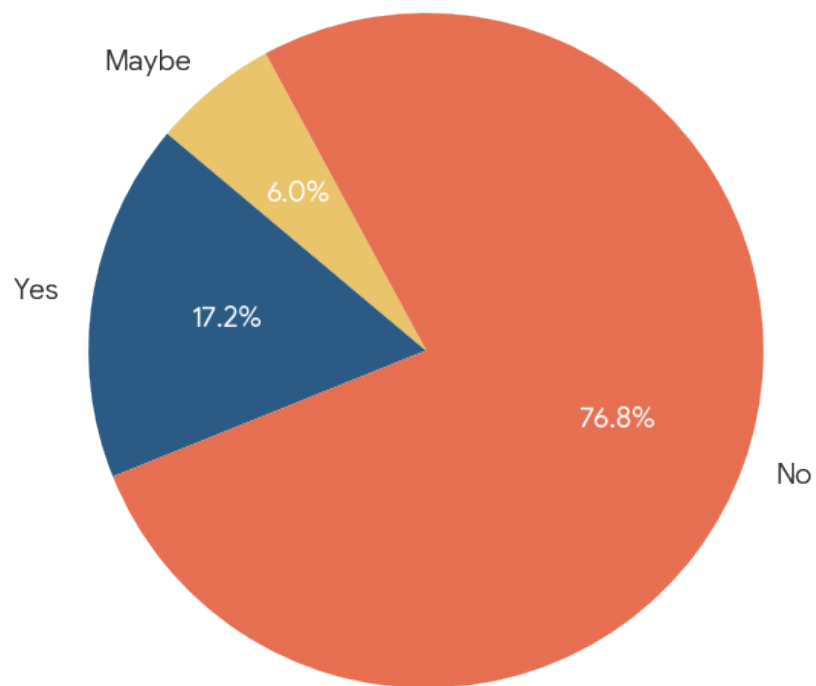
4.6 Gender-based Violence

Do you think a woman should tolerate violence of any kind to keep her family together? (98 responses)



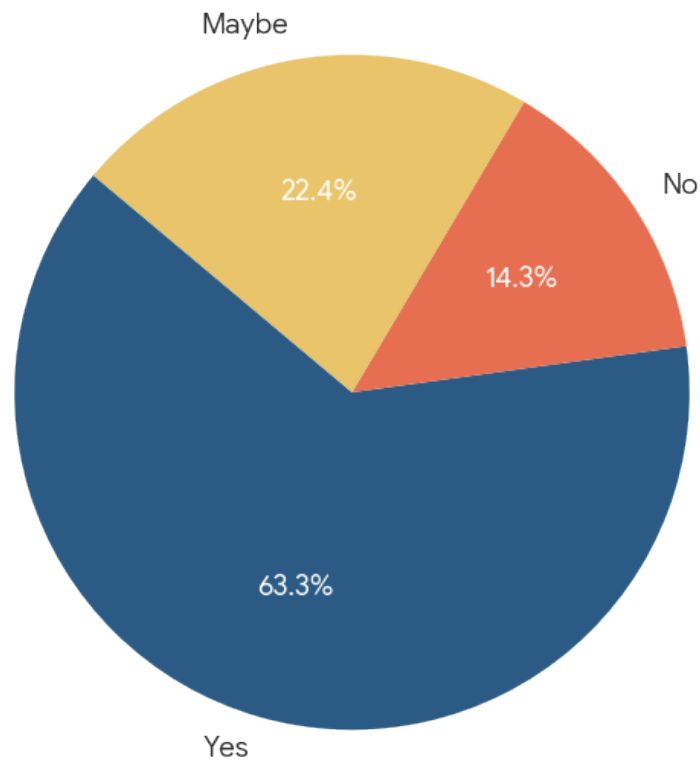
Majority (70.4%) of the respondents think that a woman should not tolerate any kind of violence to keep her family together, while 24.5% supported it and 5.1% probably supported it but were not really sure. Violence of any form detests the concept of equality and is a crime in its entirety. However, nearly one-fourth of the respondents validated it on certain grounds, which says that there is still a huge gap between the two genders.

Do you think making the opposite gender uncomfortable by cracking sexist jokes is okay? (99 responses)



Majority (76.8%) were against the idea of making the opposite gender uncomfortable by cracking sexist jokes. However, 17.2% considered this behaviour as fine and 6% probably supported it but were not sure about it.

Do you think gender sensitisation programs can help reduce incidents of gender-based violence? (98 responses)



Majority (63.3%) favoured the fact that gender sensitization programs can help reduce the incidents of gender-based violence. However, 14.3% considered this as unnecessary and 22.4% probably supported it but were not sure about it. Gender Sensitization programs make a person more sensitive towards equality and it thus can help reduce incidents of Gender-based violence. The respondents are aware of this and progressive in nature.

Chapter 5: Conclusion and Recommendations

The following conclusions can be drawn from the data above:

- (a) Nearly 60% of the young population is not aware of the differences between sex and gender. They use the words 'sex' and 'gender' interchangeably and synonymously. Sex refers to the difference biological and physiological characteristics of males and females, while gender refers to the socially constructed characteristics of men and women- such as norms, roles and relationships of men and women.
- (b) Nearly 60% of the population has never received training or education on gender-related issues.
- (c) An arithmetic mean of around 65% of young population does not believe in pre-defined gender stereotypes.
- (d) An arithmetic mean of around 78% of young population does not believe in pre-set gender roles. However, there is a possibility of difference in action and words among them.
- (e) An arithmetic mean of around 74% of the young population favours gender equality in all spheres of life.
- (f) An arithmetic mean of around 70% of the young population is against gender-based violence due to any cause.

On an average, around 70% of the young population of Kanpur city is fairly gender-sensitized. However, there is still more that needs to be done to sensitize the young population and ultimately achieve gender equality. There is a lack of training among the youth with regards to sensitization. This can be due to lack of gender sensitization programs in existence or a negligence in their implementation.

Furthermore, an average of 78% of young population actively supports inclusion of gender sensitization workshops or training or curriculum as a part of school and workplace activity. Only few schools in India like the Kendriya Vidyalaya educate students through curriculums in this domain. This should have a wide reach as Gender Sensitization can be inculcated only through education. At the administrative level, policy implementation should be properly done and feedbacks should be taken to improve the policies further.

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